GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

September 26th, 2025
Week 39
Volume 276, Issue 1204

Highlights:

Rollercoaster.

- **INR spiral.**
- **Steel decline.**
- **Pak bright.**
- **Future hopes.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"The greater the difficulty, the more the glory in surmounting it."

– *Epicurus*

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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DISCONNECT?

Global markets seem to be going through quite a disconnect of late as on the one hand, the last couple of months has seen a multitude of directions that stock markets, trading markets, charter rates, financial and FX markets, and even the ship recycling markets have been greeted by versions of unfolding realities that seem to conflict with what's been transpiring at the bidding tables of late. On the one hand, various reports have been consistently confirming positive movements in dry / trading markets, oil up and down (with more down expected), financial markets wreaking havoc on the global ship recycling industry, and ship recycling volumes seemingly improving over recent weeks (primarily in India). And this week was another roller coaster of confusion.

The Baltic Exchange Dry Bulk Index fell nearly 7 points on Friday as Capes, Panamax, and Supramax indices all slipped 14, 3, and 4 points respectively. Yet, the overall benchmark reported a net 2.5% positive gain for the entire sector, driven primarily by the strength of Capes that reportedly firmed another 5.5%. On the flip side, WTI crude slipped 1% down to USD 65 / barrel as Iraq's Kurdistan region reportedly resuming crude oil exports after a 2.5-year hiatus, adding a near 190K barrel / day output that is expected to climb to 230K bpd. The restart pushed by U.S. pressure comes as OPEC+ eyes further outputs while risks to Russian supplies linger amidst their war of attrition.

The net trickledown effect of the above coupled with a quick stop at sanctions stations has seen ship recycling nation currencies unexpectedly take a royal hammering this week as Bangladesh, India and Turkey all reported declines in their currencies once again, while local steel plate prices flatlined across the board, expect in India. Ongoing macro market movements have also seen a degree of sporadic buying return to the ship recycling markets from certain needlessly optimistic cash buyers, which has punctuated what has been an overall gloomy 2025 for the ship recycling scene where supply, demand, and pricing have all suffered tragically.

In Bangladesh, recycled product is simply refusing to shift from frustrated end buyer yards (much as we have seen for a majority of the year), leaving the overall ship recycling scene in Chattogram lost at high seas. Pakistan, and surprisingly even India, appear to be the only bright spots over recent times with an increased demand and higher indicative pricing of late, even though there is still much in terms of HKC infrastructure upgrades left to accomplish in Gadani, given that not a single ship recycling facility is HKC ready here. And Gadani buyers have been left relying on provisional DASR certificates issued by local authorities in order to continue doing business.

As Fall gets fully under way with September 2025 entering its forever slumber next week, dimly lit hopes lie in wait for brighter times ahead, for a beleaguered ship recycling industry.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 39 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

Bypassed!

Quietest.

Bangladesh remains the quietest sub-continent ship recycling destination for yet another week and there are few signs that the pervading situation is likely to improve any time soon given that the overall state of affairs (as reported over recent weeks) has simply not changed an iota. Minimal recycled ship's steel continues failing to shift from local yards due to the lack of development stimuli implemented by the interim regime (ahead of upcoming elections scheduled for February 2026).

Fundamentals too have stifled on the side of misalignment as not only did local steel plate prices fail to move - indicating that local recyclers are steadfast at current levels and refusing to buckle to the pressures of cheaper international steel imports, but the currency also started to groan like a retiree in hospice as the Taka ended the week on a lower note at BDT 122.04 against the U.S. Dollar.

Failing to secure.

And while tonnage availability has not been as big of an issue as it has been for much of the year, the state of the chartering markets has left nothing more than a healthy collection of small(er) LDT units being proposed at the bidding tables, which have remained beyond the grasps of local interests as most local buyers remain on the lookout for larger LDT units such as Capes / Panamax bulkers, which remain few and far between. Even worse? The rare few that are being proposed are being diverted towards competing India and likely even Pakistan (this week), so poor is the Bangladeshi sentiment at present.

18 yards HKC.

HKC status too remains unchanged for the most part as from the last week's count, there are still only 18 HKC compliant local facilities that are in operation, with a handful still struggling to complete their accreditation journeys. Reportedly, another 3 are set to be approved in October as Bangladesh continues to make meaningful progress with infrastructure upgrades, following the landmark entry of the Hong Kong Convention into force on June 26th.

Lucky one.

At the local waterfront, at least one decent 7K LDT tanker made it into the hands of a local recycler as Chattogram's waterfront continues to suffer week after week, virtually mirroring Pakistan's recent performance. As advised in recent reports, unless you're a lucky one with a large unit or simply don't want to head further West, then only then is Chattogram your best bet.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

TURBULENT TIMES!

India has remained on the turbulent side of economic uncertainties over the last few weeks as Rupee woes and steel declines marred Alang's ship recycling landscape over recent weeks, delivering a collection of gut punches to an already fragile sentiment. Not only has the Indian Rupee started its descent towards glooming uncertainty, but it also backed it up by declining a massive 55 basis points against the U.S. Dollar this week, ending it at INR 88.62. Of note, this was an improved ending to the Rupee's performance as it briefly broke all time historical records this week approaching dangerously close to INR 89.

Vessels diverted.

On the other side of the fundamental's coin, after weeks of flatlining like its neighbours, Indian steel plate prices slid a **whopping** USD 15/Ton and end the week it at USD 409.20/Ton, well below recent offerings and even fixtures. Given that at a time some cash buyers are feeding off a misguided interpretation by relating the recent inflow of tonnage to the possibility of an upcoming market improvement, it is simply not the case. Moreover, while some recent sales have also tickled the limits of prevailing levels, it may be that the owners of these units could well face problems upon arrival at Alang should the Rupee's and steel's performance continue migrating South for the winter months.

Container sold.

Resultingly, it was of little surprise to see active negotiations on several vessels slow down amidst the disastrous decline in fundamentals this week, with reports of some working vessels being potentially diverted to competing markets (i.e. Pakistan), so terribly has the local situation deteriorated in India. In fact, there were two dry bulk sales into Pakistan to report and only one small tanker and one container into India, and that too at a curiously high and speculative level from the concerned cash buyer as Sinokor sold their 1997 Netherlands built (with steel propeller) NIIGATA TRADER (4,810 LDT) at USD 480/LT LDT with 120 Tons of bunkers ROB – certainly not a viable or realistic price today based on local fundamentals.

Fundamentals fail.

As the INR continues down this disastrous and historical spiral since President Trump launched his traction-less sanction action on the world along with maddening 50% tariffs on India for their tolerance of and business dealings with Russia on energy trade, Q4 might just turn into a Pakistan only game. This week, however, Alang simultaneously surprised with fresh tonnage at the waterfront and another cape arriving locally.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
NIIGATA TRADER	Container	4,810	USD 480/LT LDT (with 120 Ts bunkers ROB)
TUKTUK	Tanker	2,948	USD 425/LT LDT

PAKISTAN

BAGGING BULK!

Over the line.

After nearly a month on the sidelines with empty port positions by the week, deals finally appear to have been concluded into a resurgent (and hungry) Gadani market this week, with several bulkers being reportedly sold to local recyclers including a unit likely inbound all the way from Indonesia, bypassing the traditionally hungrier Bangladesh and even Indian markets.

To start, the RISING HARRIER 8,600 LDT) was concluded for a decent USD 445/LT LDT from Middle East owners (with 150 Tons of bunkers included in the sale), whilst the PUTERI KIRANA (8,082 LDT) managed to fetch a fine USD 390/LT LDT basis an 'as is' Surabaya delivery and likely Gadani resale, wrapping up the two handy sales for the week.

Hmax sales.

Local port position also surprised the industry with at least one (but small LDT) handy finding its destination to a local recycler's yard. Clearly, these DASR certifications are coming in at a hefty cost as this sub 3K LDT fixture highlights the growing desperation of local recyclers.

Fundamentals meanwhile continue to support the local mindset as not only have local steel plate prices continued to dominate the competing sub-continent steel charts for several months now, but they also remain flatlined at levels strong enough that seem determined to trudge through Trump's uneducated business moves. The Pakistani Rupee also firmed a healthy 30 basis points against the U.S. Dollar this week to end it at PKR 282.50.

Working hard.

At the macro end, Pakistan is also idling with tariffs at a far lower 20% compared to Bangladesh's 30% and 50% on India, making it increasingly seem as though the lack of HKC fervor was joined by local inaction towards a timely initiation of upgrades that have ended up partying hard into the night and created the tonnage hangover that the Gadani Gang continues to endure. And while the local buyers continue to work hard at getting their facilities up to HKC standards, the number of recyclers willing to negotiate on a majority of the market offerings, remains in the air.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
PUTERI KIRANA	Bulker	8,082	USD 390/LT LDT ('as is' Surabaya)
RISING HARRIER	Bulker	8,600	USD 445/LT LDT (with 150 Ts bunkers on dely)

TURKEY

SNOOZE!

Lira drops 46 basis points to end the week at TRY 41.58 while steel continues to face a marginal dithering with every passing week. Not much else to report.

Dithering.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 39 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *I was pleased to find out that a buttload is an actual unit of measurement! One buttload is equivalent to 126 gallons of wine.*
- *Back in the day, Victorians ate arsenic to get a paler complexion.*
- *There's a church decorated with the bones of 40,000 people in Czechia.*
- *There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.*
- *Humans typically produce 0.5 to 1.5 liters of saliva every day.*
- *Crocodiles can gallop like horses do.*
- *If you're afraid to go into the ocean because of sharks, you might want to avoid hotel hallways and break rooms, because vending machines are twice as likely to kill you.*
- *Though dead bones are dry and brittle, living bones are wet and a bit soft. In order to absorb pressure, bones are also slightly flexible. Up to one-third of a living bone's weight is water.*
- *"Gnurr" is the term used to describe the lint that collects at the bottom of your pockets.*
- *The closest US state to Africa is Maine.*
- *If you sneeze uncontrollably after being suddenly exposed to bright light or intense sunlight, you might have inherited a genetic trait called Achoo Syndrome.*
- *Armadillos almost always give birth to identical quadruplets.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 02 – Dussehra / Gandhi Jayanthi October 03 – Durga Puja October 22 – Diwali	October 05 – October 13 October 20 – October 26

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 01 & 02 – Durga Puja	October 06 – October 09 October 20 – October 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
October 24 – Founding Day	October 28 & 29 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ali S	4,869	Buk Carrier	Arrived September 22
2	*Bonita*	*10,201*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered September 24*
3	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
4	*Ema*	*9,023*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered September 24*
5	*Gas Pioneer*	*1,140*	*LPG*	*Delivered September 24*
6	*Kavita*	*6,614*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered September 25*
7	*Kosta*	*20,841*	*Buk Carrier*	*Delivered September 26*
8	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
9	*Rising Eagle*	*5,440*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered September 25*
10	*Sia 12*	*1,788*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered September 25*
Total Tonnage		**89,540**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Crystal*	*7,052*	*Tanker*	*Delivered September 22*
2	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
		14,861		

GADANI - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Joyo 6*	*2,894*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered September 19*
Total Tonnage		**2,894**		

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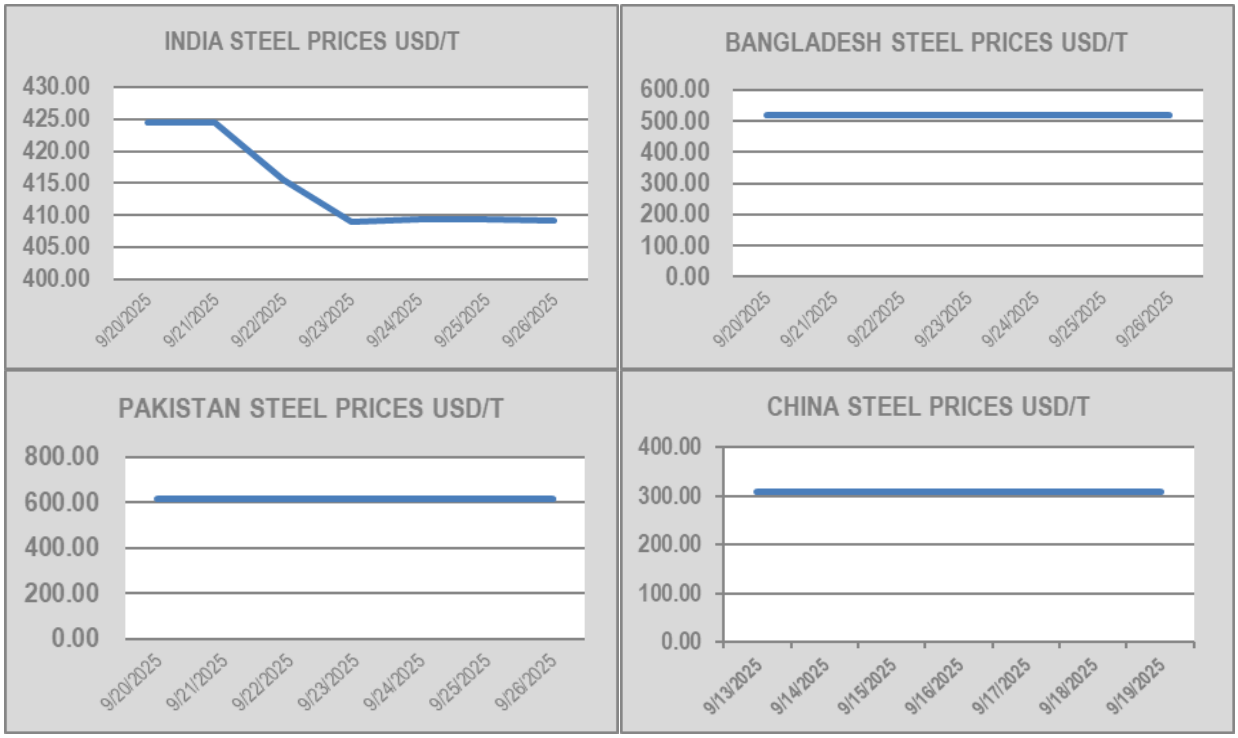
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/20/2025	424.52	37,400.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/21/2025	424.52	37,400.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/22/2025	415.58	36,700.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/23/2025	408.97	36,300.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/24/2025	409.29	36,300.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/25/2025	409.38	36,300.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/26/2025	409.20	36,300.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17



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